Doctoral Degree Steps to Completion

Administrative Program Coordinator & Doctoral Student Support



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Office of Graduate Studies

Throughout these steps to degree completion, Lisa will be answering your questions and reviewing your materials.

Please submit all DOCTORAL forms to graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu).

Related resources

- Certification of Full-Time Status [https://go.unl.edu/gradfulltime]
- Academic Leave Form [https://cms.unl.edu/executive-vice-chancellor/graduate-studies/academics/academic-leave/]
- Extension Request Form [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Program-Extension-Request-accessible-2026.pdf]

Expected Graduation Date Required

May 2027

Collapse All

NOTE: Departments may have earlier deadlines. Please check with your advisor or graduate handbook.

▼ Supervisory Committee

Deadline: Prior to the completion of half of the required coursework.

What to submit: Appointment of Supervisory Committee form

When to submit: Prior to completing half of the coursework, including transfer hours, but excluding research or language tools.

Who to submit to: graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu)

You will be notified by email when your committee is approved.
For full policy, see Supervisory Committee [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements/#supervisory] in the Graduate Catalog.

Form: Appointment of Supervisory Committee [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Doctoral-Supervisory-Committee-accessible-2026.pdf]

Form: Change of Supervisory Committee [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Doctoral-Supervisory-Committee-Change-accessible-2026.pdf]

Form: Special Committee Member [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Doctoral-Special-Committee-Member-accessible-2026.pdf]

▼ Program of Studies

Deadline: Prior to the completion of half of the required coursework.

What to submit: Program of Studies form

When to submit: Prior to completing half of the coursework, including transfer hours.

Note: Program of Study forms will not be accepted unless an Appointment of Supervisory Committee form has been submitted.

Who to submit to: graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu)

NOTE: Requests to change an approved Program of Studies must be submitted by the student's major advisor via email to the graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu). DO NOT submit a new Program of Studies.

For full policy, see Program of Studies [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements#program-of-studies] in the Graduate Catalog.

Form: Program of Studies [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Program-of-Studies-accessible-2026.pdf]

▼ Comprehensive Examination & Candidacy

Deadline: **November 1**

What to submit: Application for Admission to Candidacy form

When to submit: After successful completion of the comprehensive examination, no later than **November 1**

Who to submit to: graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu)

For full policy, including registration requirements, see Comprehensive Examination [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements/#exam] and Candidacy [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements/#candidacy] in the Graduate Catalog.

The comprehensive examination must be completed **at least 7 months** prior to graduation.

The Application for Admission to Candidacy form must be submitted when language and research tool requirements have been met and the comprehensive examination(s) have been passed.

Form: Application for Admission to Candidacy [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Doctoral-Candidacy-Application-accessible-2026.pdf]

▼ Application for Graduation

Deadline: **January 22**

What to submit:

- Complete the Application for Graduation in MyRED [https://myred.nebraska.edu]. As a doctoral student, you will also be required to complete the Hooding Participation information included in the application process.

When to submit: The Application for Graduation and Hooding Participation form must be completed no later than: **January 22**

The online Application for Graduation will become available in MyRED [https://myred.nebraska.edu] the semester following Admission to Candidacy.

Your participation in the commencement ceremony will be requested by the Registrar later in the semester.

▼ Application for Final Oral Examination

Deadline: **April 8**

What to submit: Application for Final Oral Examination form, with signatures of the two readers, supervisory committee chair(s), your department's graduate program chair.

When to submit: At least 2 weeks prior to Final Oral Examination. Last date to submit the Application for Final Oral Examination: **April 8**

Last day to hold Final Oral Examination: ***April 22***

Who to submit to: graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu)

For full policy see Final Oral Examination [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements/#Dissertation-and-Final-Oral-Exam] in the Graduate Catalog.

Form: Application for Final Oral Examination [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Doctoral-Final-Oral-accessible-2026.pdf]

▼ Near Final Dissertation/Document Review

Deadline: **April 8**

What to submit: full dissertation/document rough draft, including title page and abstract.

The formatting will be reviewed and students will be notified of any needed changes. No content will be reviewed. Any formatting changes must be made prior to final dissertation deposit.

When to submit: Submit Rough draft with Application for Final Oral Examination at least 2 weeks prior to Final Oral Examination. Last date to submit the Application for Final Oral Examination: **April 8**

Who to submit to: graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu)

For full policy see Dissertation [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements/#dissertation] in the Graduate Catalog.

- Formatting resource: Preparing a Dissertation (/academics/degrees/guidelines).
- Following approval by the major advisor, the dissertation and abstract should be presented to the Reading Committee for review at least four weeks prior to the oral examination (defense).

▼ Dissertation Defense

Deadline: **April 22**

▼ Final Dissertation Defense/Document Review

Deadline: **April 23**

What to submit: Final and complete dissertation as a PDF

When to submit: after successful completion of your final oral examination, and no later than **April 23**

Who to submit to: graduatedocuments@unl.edu (mailto:graduatedocuments@unl.edu)
Student will be notified when dissertation has been approved for upload to ProQuest (required) and UNL Digital Commons (optional).

For full policy see Dissertation and Final Oral Examination [https://catalog.unl.edu/graduate-professional/policies/academic-program-requirements/#dissertation] in the Graduate Catalog.

▼ Upload to ProQuest and UNL Digital Commons

Deadline: **April 23**

What to submit: Final and approved dissertation in .pdf format.
ProQuest will recognize you are a UNL student and not require payment for basic upload. If placing an embargo, ProQuest will delay distribution of your dissertation. You will need to be specific about the length of time.

If requesting copyright registration through ProQuest, complete the additional ProQuest form and pay the associated fee.

When to submit: After final formatting approval has been given by Graduate Studies. No later than: **April 23**

Who to submit to: ProQuest [https://www.etdadmin.com/unl]

NOTE:

- *While immediate publication in both ProQuest and the UNL Digital Commons is recommended, there is an option to temporarily restrict access to dissertations, known as embargoing [https://graduate.unl.edu/academics/program-steps/doctoral-degree-steps-to-completion/embargo].*
- *Dissertations will be uploaded to UNL Digital Commons as well as to ProQuest, unless an embargo is requested.*
- *If you choose to embargo your dissertation, it will be uploaded to ProQuest on the embargo expiry date, but not to the UNL Digital Commons unless otherwise requested.*
- *Upload only after approval by Graduate Studies.*

▼ Deposit Fees

Deadline: **April 23**

What to submit: Doctoral deposit fee - $25.00 (required)

When to submit: No later than: **April 23**

How to submit: Paid in MyRED [https://myred.nebraska.edu] (To-do list) by credit or debit card.

NOTE: This payment is not part of your student account. You will receive email confirmation of this payment. This is in addition to the $25 Application for Graduation fee paid at the beginning of the semester.

▼ Report of Completion and Abstract Upload

Deadline: **April 23**

What to submit:

- Report of Completion form signed by committee and Graduate Program Chair
  NOTE: A majority of the committee must be in attendance and sign the Report of Completion form.
- Abstract
  NOTE: Abstracts must be submitted in the exact format as your dissertation/document, including your title, university, name, etc.

When to submit: After your defense and no later than: **April 23**

Who to submit to: Upload Report of Completion & Abstract here (/academics/program-steps/doctoral-degree-steps-to-completion/required-dissertation-actions-uploads)

Note: Ph.D. students must complete the Survey of Earned Doctorates [https://sed-ncses.org/]. The Doctoral Programs Coordinator will automatically receive a notice of completion.

Note: Committee Chairs are responsible for submitting final 999 grades. Submit outstanding incomplete/no report grades for 999 credits by following this link: Thesis/Dissertation Grade Change [https://myred.nebraska.edu/psc/myred/NBL/HRMS/s/WEBLIB_ENTREDIR.ISCRIPT1.FieldFormula.IScript_Redirect?nba-product=EF&cref=NBL_NVC_DS_EFORM_SR_GRD_FNL]

Form: Report of Completion [https://graduate.unl.edu/sites/unl.edu.executive-vice-chancellor.graduate-studies/files/media/file/Doctoral-Completion-Report-accessible-2026.pdf]

The PDF forms on this page are Reader-Enabled: you can type in the form, save the PDF on your computer, then later reopen the file and change what you typed — if you use a current version of Adobe Acrobat software, such as the free Acrobat Reader [http://get.adobe.com/reader/]. Other PDF-reading software may or may not support these features. See also: Troubleshooting Forms (current/troubleshooting-forms).